

Conversation

#13

CONVERSATION

MORNING MEETING – WHEN PRESSURE HITS THE BOARDROOM

Teacher's note: get 8 pieces of papers, number them 1 to 8 and have each student draw one, to see which character they will be. This activity focuses on **professional communication, problem-solving, and leadership language**.

It's 9:00 a.m. on Monday at LogiSmart Brasil S.A., São Paulo.

Last week, the company **missed a critical delivery deadline** for a major client. As a result, performance dropped, costs increased, and complaints multiplied.

Early this morning, the CEO sent a short and direct email:

"This cannot happen again. I want accountability and fast solutions."

The operations team is now in the meeting room. The numbers are on the screen.

Everyone knows this meeting will define trust, leadership, and next steps.

Operational Data

Indicator	Normal Level	Last Week	Target
On-time delivery	96%	88%	95%
Average delay	1.2 hrs	4.6 hrs	≤ 2 hrs
Overtime cost	R\$120,000	R\$165,000	R\$130,000
Client complaints	3	11	≤ 4
Orders at risk	0	2 major clients	0

Student Coaching – How to Use the Data

- Use the numbers to support your arguments
- Point to the table when speaking
- Defend your department or challenge others using the data
- Propose actions that change at least one number next week

1. Lucas – Operations Manager

"I walk into this meeting knowing everyone is watching me. Eighty-eight percent on-time delivery is unacceptable, and the CEO made that very clear this morning.

I don't want excuses and I don't want finger-pointing. What I need are clear actions and real ownership.

If this meeting turns into a fight, I fail as a leader. If it ends with solutions, we move forward."

2. Mariana – Project Coordinator

"As soon as I see the numbers, I know they point to my project. The delay didn't happen because I ignored the process — the supplier changed the schedule at the last minute.

Still, I feel exposed. I want them to know I'm not avoiding responsibility. I just need the space to explain what happened and show that I already have a plan."

3. Diego – Logistics Supervisor

“I’m tired of logistics being blamed for problems that start long before delivery. We reacted fast. We rerouted trucks and worked overtime.

When I look at the data, I don’t see a logistics failure — I see poor planning. And this is not the first time.

Someone needs to say it, even if it sounds harsh.”

4. Sofia – Procurement Lead

“I can feel the tension rising, and I know how dangerous that can be. Suppliers are under pressure, yes, but we still have options.

There are alternative partners and faster routes, but only if we stay calm. I don’t want this meeting to turn into a departmental war.

My role is to reduce risk and help the team move forward.”

5. Carla – Finance Analyst

“What worries me most is not the delay itself — it’s the cost of fixing it. Overtime jumped to R\$165,000, and that’s not sustainable.

Every emergency decision weakens the budget. If we normalize this, it will happen again.

I’m here to protect financial discipline, even when it’s uncomfortable.”

6. Rafael – Quality Control Specialist

“Everyone talks about speed, but few talk about consequences. When deliveries are rushed, quality suffers — and the complaints prove that.

Eleven complaints in one week is a warning sign.

If we keep pushing faster deliveries, returns and damage will increase.

I may sound pessimistic, but I’m thinking long term.”

7. João – Marketing Manager

“When clients complain, they don’t call logistics — they call marketing. Right now, the phone hasn’t stopped ringing.

There’s a campaign launching in three days, and any delay will hurt our credibility.

I don’t care who’s right in this room. What I need is certainty and guarantees.”

8. Ana – Executive Assistant

“I listen, I take notes, and I try to organize the chaos.

If this meeting ends without clear decisions, nothing changes. So I focus on actions, deadlines, and names.

At the end, my job is simple:

turn confusion into a clear summary and responsibilities everyone understands.”

Title: _____

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